



New Food Innovation

PLANT-BASED CHEESE

# Coconut Cheddar v3

NFI COMMERCIAL DECISION REPORT

GO

SENSORY DECISION



DIRECTIONAL CONCEPT VISUAL

DECISION SNAPSHOT

## PRODUCT DECISION: GO

READINESS STAGE

Approved for launch preparation · claims evidence limited

01

### NFI VIEW · WHAT THE DECISION MEANS

The product clears the sensory decision gate and can proceed into launch preparation. Concept evidence is directional only and should not be used for demand, preference, purchase-intent, price, or final packaging claims.

ISSF SCORE

82.4

EVIDENCE STRENGTH

86/100

CONCEPT EVIDENCE

n=24 · directional only

CORE STRENGTH

Overall sensory acceptance (84/100) is the strongest documented sensory result.

MAIN WATCH POINT

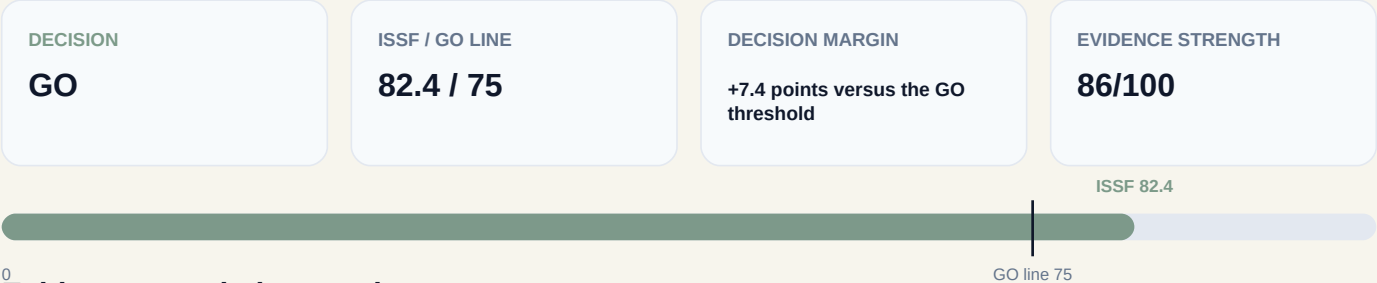
Concept evidence is directional only; consumer and market claims require broader validation.

### NFI VIEW · RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTION

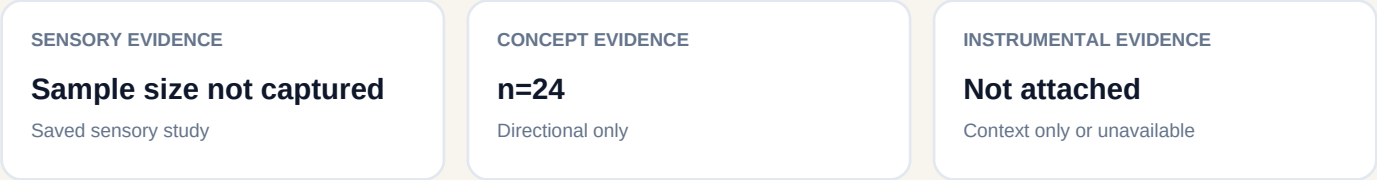
Proceed with launch preparation. Confirm pilot-scale product performance, then build the claim-ready launch story through target-consumer validation, packaging approval, and claims/legal review.

# Decision basis, evidence strength, and product gates

Why the decision was reached, how strong the evidence is, and which changes would require a new review.



## Evidence populations and provenance



NFI VIEW · WHAT THIS MEANS

The product has cleared the internal product decision gate. The next question is not whether the tested sample can advance; it is whether the formula, packaging, claims, and commercial case can be validated for release.

Decision gates

What would change the decision

● Off-note control · PASS

No material off-note gate remains open.

● Instrument quality control · PASS

Instrument recovery is inside the method range.

- The current score is 7.4 points above the GO threshold.

- Texture performance is the nearest sensory constraint at 68/100, 8 points above the readiness line.

- A critical product-gate failure, invalid evidence, ISSF below 75, or a required dimension below 60 would require a new decision review.

- MATERIAL LIMITATIONS
- Concept evidence is below the n>=30 operational threshold (current n=24).

- External claims require claim-specific substantiation and approval.

MANAGEMENT DECISION · DRAFT FOR REVIEW

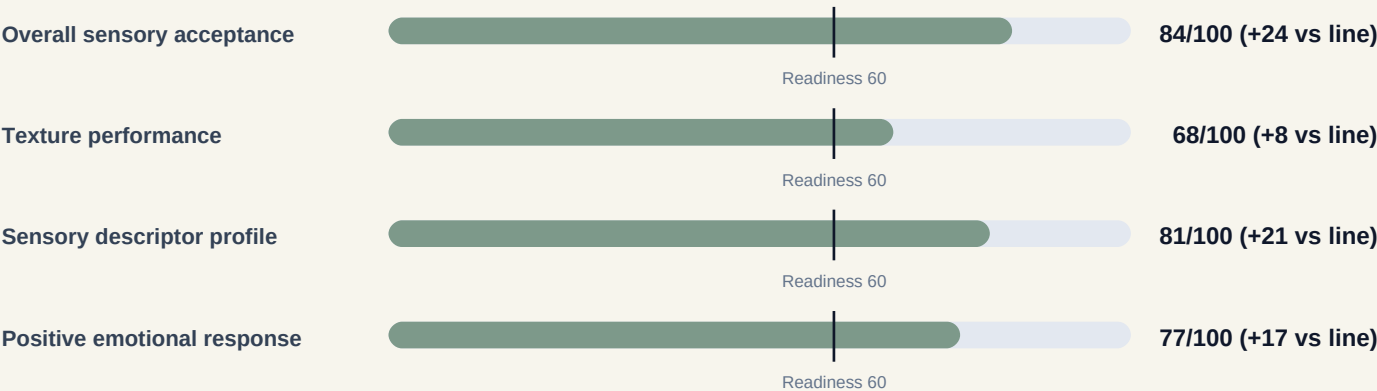
Authorize controlled launch preparation and the named validation work. Do not authorize consumer, demand, price, packaging-preference, nutrition, health, or superiority claims at this stage.

# Sensory performance against the readiness line

03

Measured sensory performance, study basis, benchmark context, and the implications to protect through scale-up.

## Dimension performance



### OVERALL SENSORY ACCEPTANCE

Sensory screening result

Readiness line 60/100

Acceptance supports moving the product into the next validation round.

### TEXTURE PERFORMANCE

Sensory screening result

Readiness line 60/100

Texture is viable but should be monitored through scale-up.

### SENSORY DESCRIPTOR PROFILE

Sensory screening result

Readiness line 60/100

The sensory profile is recognizable and category-relevant.

### POSITIVE EMOTIONAL RESPONSE INDICATORS

Sensory screening result

Readiness line 60/100

Positive response supports the direction, but remains secondary evidence.

### NFI VIEW · WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUPPORTS

The product cleared the internal sensory screen. Acceptance, texture, descriptor fit, and emotional response support launch preparation and pilot-scale confirmation.

### WHAT IS NOT YET PROVEN

Concept response is n=24. Do not treat purchase intent, price feedback, packaging preference, or concept descriptors as representative market evidence.

Study basis: sensory screening plus concept test n=24. Scores are shown on a 0–100 scale. Evidence caveat: variability and agreement statistics were not included in this report snapshot and should be added to the next validation round.

# Instrumental evidence, scientific guidance, and product risk

Project measurements show whether the sensory result is technically coherent; literature is used beside the evidence to shape the next validation method.

INSTRUMENTAL STATUS · NOT AVAILABLE

No project instrumental dataset is attached to this saved report version.

## Technical and execution risks

PRODUCT RISK · NEXT GATE PILOT VALIDATION

Reduce late-stage gumminess and confirm melt performance after pilot-scale processing.

Impact: A changed or inconsistent product experience could invalidate the current sensory screening outcome.

Control: Set pilot-scale acceptance ranges and repeat the critical sensory measures.

CONCEPT/PACKAGING RISK · NEXT GATE DESIGN REVIEW

Directional packaging may be mistaken for a finished pack.

Impact: Buyer feedback may focus on unfinished design choices instead of the product proposition.

Control: Label the stimulus as directional and complete design refinement before external use.

CLAIMS RISK · NEXT GATE CLAIMS APPROVAL

Sensory and concept results do not independently substantiate broad benefit claims.

Impact: Unsupported copy creates legal exposure and can undermine buyer confidence.

Control: Create a claim-by-claim evidence matrix and obtain legal approval.

## NFI view · Scientific guidance applied to the next study

[L1] Texture and mouthfeel confirmation

Keep texture and mouthfeel measures in the pilot confirmation plan because structure strongly shapes the plant-based cheese experience.

[L2] Target-consumer validation

Benchmark the correct product format and confirm positioning and usage cues with the intended consumer group.

VERIFIED SOURCES:

[L1] Texture drivers in plant-based cheese alternatives

[L2] Consumer acceptance of plant-based foods

# Product readiness: sensory GO, technical checks pending

Product readiness separates the validated product evidence from the technical work still required for a repeatable, compliant launch product.

|                                     |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sensory performance                 | <div>CURRENT EVIDENCE</div> <div>ISSF 82.4; sensory panel size not documented.</div>                                           | <div>REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE</div> <div>Repeat the critical sensory measures on the pilot-scale product.</div> <div>READY</div>                                  |
| Instrumental confirmation           | <div>CURRENT EVIDENCE</div> <div>No project instrumental findings are attached.</div>                                          | <div>REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE</div> <div>Define instrumental specifications and collect project measurements.</div> <div>EVIDENCE GAP</div>                       |
| Pilot manufacturing                 | <div>CURRENT EVIDENCE</div> <div>No validated pilot-batch or process-capability record is included.</div>                      | <div>REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE</div> <div>Pilot batch record, process window, yield, variability, and release specifications.</div> <div>PENDING</div>             |
| Packaging compatibility             | <div>CURRENT EVIDENCE</div> <div>A directional visual exists; technical pack performance is untested.</div>                    | <div>REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE</div> <div>Pack specification, line trial, seal/leak testing, compatibility, and transport validation.</div> <div>IN PROGRESS</div> |
| Regulatory, labeling, and nutrition | <div>CURRENT EVIDENCE</div> <div>No signed ingredient, allergen, nutrition, naming, label, or claims review is included.</div> | <div>REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE</div> <div>Approved ingredient list, allergen assessment, nutrition panel, legal name, and label review.</div> <div>PENDING</div>   |

|                                                                                                                                                                        |  |  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
| NFI VIEW · PRODUCT READINESS CONCLUSION                                                                                                                                |  |  |
| The tested product is ready for controlled launch preparation. Production release still requires pilot reproducibility, packaging validation, and regulatory approval. |  |  |

## The proposition is defined; market proof and economics remain open

The working consumer proposition is clear enough to test, while the evidence required for pricing, demand, channel, and investment decisions remains incomplete.

WORKING PROPOSITION

### Everyday Melt

Coconut Cheddar v3 is a familiar plant-based cheese proposition built around the strongest validated sensory cues.

PRIORITY CONSUMER

Flexitarian households seeking an easy dairy swap without sacrificing familiar flavor

PROMISE

A credible plant-based cheese option that feels familiar and easy to use.

PRICE HYPOTHESIS

Test \$5.99 per 7 oz pack against category alternatives.

COMMERCIAL EVIDENCE COVERAGE



DIRECTIONAL CONCEPT VISUAL · CONCEPT EVIDENCE  
BOUNDARY · Concept test n=24  
0 ready · 2 active · 5 evidence gaps



● In progress 2   ● Evidence gap 4   ● Requires validation 1

CURRENT STATUS

#### ● Consumer proposition

REQUIRES VALIDATION

Positioning and proposition: In progress · Target-consumer validation: Requires validation   Test proposition clarity and fit with matched target consumers.

#### ● Economics and route to market

EVIDENCE GAP

Unit economics: Evidence gap · Channel and buyer strategy: Evidence gap   Approve unit economics, priority channel, and buyer requirements.

REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE

#### ● Competition and price

EVIDENCE GAP

Competitive benchmark: Evidence gap · Price architecture: In progress   Benchmark named alternatives and validate price and value.

#### ● Demand plan

EVIDENCE GAP

Demand and launch forecast: Evidence gap   Build a documented forecast from validated demand inputs.

NFI VIEW · COMMERCIAL CONCLUSION

Commercial development can continue, but investment approval requires a validated consumer case, competitive and price evidence, unit economics, a defined channel, and a documented launch forecast.

## Three workstreams convert product GO into launch readiness

Three programs close the remaining product, commercial, packaging, regulatory, and approval gaps.

1

Pilot manufacturing and product confirmation

WHY THIS WORK

Confirm repeatability and sensory consistency after scale-up.

PROTOCOL

Run representative pilot batches; repeat the critical sensory and instrumental measures; confirm process settings, yield, variability, and finished-product specifications. Evidence: Approved pilot-batch record and QC report.

PASS / NEXT GATE

Agreed sensory, quality, yield, and process criteria pass on representative pilot batches. Next gate: Pilot validation.

Owner: Product + Quality

Timing: Next pilot cycle

Budget: Not yet costed

IF NOT MET

Hold release, correct the failure, and repeat the affected validation.

2

Consumer, competition, price, and commercial economics

WHY THIS WORK

Market proof and economics remain unvalidated.

PROTOCOL

Run a powered target-consumer study; benchmark alternatives; test proposition and price; model product, pack, logistics, margin, trade spend, and launch investment. Evidence: Consumer dataset, benchmark, price architecture, and...

PASS / NEXT GATE

Concept n>=30 with documented panel fit; approved benchmark, price, margin, and launch scenarios. Use at least 30 matched consumers for a directional read; use a powered sample for pricing, forecasting, or investment decisions. Next gate: Investment review.

Owner: Insights + Commercial

Timing: Before buyer review

Budget: Not yet costed

IF NOT MET

Revise the proposition, price, economics, or channel and repeat the failed gate.

3

Packaging, regulatory, claims, and launch approval

WHY THIS WORK

The final pack and external statements require approval.

PROTOCOL

Validate pack and line performance; approve ingredients, allergens, nutrition, naming, labeling, and claims; complete launch review. Evidence: Approved pack, line trial, label, claims matrix, and launch record.

PASS / NEXT GATE

Pack tests pass; regulatory, legal, quality, and commercial approve release. Next gate: Launch approval.

Owner: Packaging + Regulatory

Timing: Before external release

Budget: Not yet costed

IF NOT MET

Do not release the affected element until corrected and approved.

NFI VIEW · NEXT DECISION GATE

Move from launch preparation to launch execution only after pilot approval, commercial investment review, and packaging/regulatory launch approval.

# Claims release status by evidence level

08

Current release boundary: The product may be described as approved for launch preparation based on the tested sensory screen. Consumer preference, demand, price acceptance, purchase intent, packaging preference, nutrition, health, or superiority claims are not available until validated and approved.

|                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>SUPPORTED</div> <div>EVIDENCE</div> <div>GO at ISSF 82.4; Sensory panel size not documented.</div>                                            | <div>Product advancement decision</div> <div>PERMITTED WORDING</div> <div>Approved to proceed into launch preparation.</div>                                     | <div>INTERNAL DECISION STATEMENT</div> <div>REQUIREMENT</div> <div>Limited to the tested product and study conditions.</div>                                    |
| <div>SUPPORTED</div> <div>EVIDENCE</div> <div>Acceptance 84/100; texture 68/100.</div>                                                             | <div>Tested sensory results</div> <div>PERMITTED WORDING</div> <div>Report the measured results with sample size and study basis.</div>                          | <div>INTERNAL DECISION STATEMENT</div> <div>REQUIREMENT</div> <div>Repeat at pilot scale before production-performance claims.</div>                            |
| <div>BLOCKED</div> <div>EVIDENCE</div> <div>Concept and purchase-intent observations exist at n=24; market and price representativeness a...</div> | <div>Consumer demand, price, and purchase intent</div> <div>PERMITTED WORDING</div> <div>No external demand, price-acceptance, or purchase-intent wording.</div> | <div>EXTERNAL CLAIM</div> <div>REQUIREMENT</div> <div>Complete target-consumer validation at n&gt;=30 with documented panel fit. Use a realistic price...</div> |
| <div>BLOCKED</div> <div>EVIDENCE</div> <div>The selected visual is a directional concept stimulus, not approved final artwork.</div>               | <div>Packaging preference</div> <div>PERMITTED WORDING</div> <div>Directional packaging hypothesis for research use only.</div>                                  | <div>EXTERNAL CLAIM</div> <div>REQUIREMENT</div> <div>Complete packaging validation, design approval, and legal review.</div>                                   |
| <div>BLOCKED</div> <div>EVIDENCE</div> <div>No claim-specific substantiation is included in this report.</div>                                     | <div>Nutrition, health, or superiority benefits</div> <div>PERMITTED WORDING</div> <div>None until substantiated and approved.</div>                             | <div>EXTERNAL CLAIM</div> <div>REQUIREMENT</div> <div>Create a claim-specific evidence file and obtain legal approval.</div>                                    |

NFI RELEASE VIEW · REPORT STATUS · DRAFT FOR REVIEW

External distribution is pending report approval. No external marketing claim is authorized until its specific evidence and approval requirement is complete.